

changeling's chimerical and physical bodies simultaneously, and the changeling loses a point of Glamour for every health level of damage suffered. For example, a changeling who suffers three health levels of damage from a cold iron dagger will take three levels of aggravated chimerical damage and three levels of aggravated physical damage, and lose three points of Glamour.

Cold iron is not what most modern humans think of as iron. Stainless steel or cast iron do not produce the same effects when used as weapons against changelings. Only iron ore heated over a charcoal flame can produce cold iron — the substance produced is more commonly known as wrought iron in the modern world. This black metal can be hammered into virtually any shape, including weapons. Large weapons made of cold iron, such as swords, are brittle and do not hold an edge well, and are typically unwieldy, adding 1 or 2 to the difficulty of combat rolls made with them. If the user botches this roll, the weapon breaks. Smaller examples of cold iron weapons do not suffer this penalty, so the most common uses of cold iron as a weapon are as daggers, arrowheads, and the like.

Forging a cold iron weapon is illegal in virtually every kingdom, and even owning one is a crime in most — this does not mean, of course, that such weapons do not exist. Such weapons are usually made by mortal blacksmiths who have no idea what the “display weapon” they’re making will be used for. Sometimes mages are contracted for such work, as some of them can forge cold iron blades with the strength of steel. It is said that a cold iron blade quenched in the blood of a changeling thirsts for more, and thereafter does not cause the discomfort in the Kithain that the presence of cold iron usually engenders. Such weapons are little more than an urban myth, but even the most outrageous legend frequently holds a kernel of truth.

Physical Healing Times

Level	Bashing	Lethal
Bruised	One Hour	One Day
Hurt	One Hour	Three Days
Injured	One Hour	One Week
Wounded	One Hour	One Month
Mauled	Three Hours	Three Months
Crippled	Six Hours	Three Months
Incapacitated	12 Hours	Five Months

Chimerical Healing Times

Level	Bashing	Lethal
Bruised	30 Minutes	Six Hours
Hurt	30 Minutes	12 Hours
Injured	One Hour	One Day
Wounded	One Hour	Three Days
Mauled	One Hour	Five Days
Crippled	Three Hours	One Week
Incapacitated	Six Hours	Three Weeks

Death

Changelings recover quickly from injury with the appropriate aid, but they are still mortal. Their dual nature complicates things, however, as changelings have many ways to die, and not all of them are permanent.

Chimerical Death

Chimerical death occurs when the changeling suffers more lethal or aggravated chimerical damage than she has chimerical health levels. The changeling passes out immediately, and when she awakens she suffers from the Mists, all memories of her fae life inaccessible. At best she remembers them as a dream, or perhaps a nightmare. Her Fae nature can be restored after a certain amount of time, depending on her Banality rating (see the Mists chart on p. 269), with an infusion of Glamour. Those who suffer a chimerical death while in the Dreaming are expelled from it, waking up in the Autumn world with no memory of how they got there.

The guttering flames of Glamour that accompany chimerical death draws in Banality like a beacon. A character who suffers chimerical death accrues half her Banality rating (rounded up) in points of Banality.

Banal Death

Banal death occurs when the changeling suffers more levels of lethal or aggravated physical damage than she has physical health levels. Her human body is slain, and her faerie soul slips away to be reborn once again. Banal Death in the Dreaming, when it occurs, is a strange and eerie experience. The faerie soul rises from the human body, a semi-living monument to what she once was, the memories of her life slowly slipping away. The souls of commoners or Autumn sidhe immediately make for the physical world, and vanish when they cross the borders of the Dreaming. The souls of Arcadian sidhe venture off into the Dreaming itself, leaving the Silver Path far behind. In either case, they defy all attempts to follow them for more than a brief period, the call of their next life too strong to resist.

Fae Death

Most tragic of all, Fae Death occurs only when cold iron is used to strike a death blow. The result is an irrevocable loss of a faerie soul — it will never again be reborn in a mortal host. The dream that she embodies is lost forever. No greater crime exists amongst the Kithain, and those who are known to have carried it out are widely distrusted and loathed — the appellation “kinslayer” is not an uncommon one in such a case — assuming they survive the ire of their fellows.

Sources of Injury

In the Dreaming as in the Autumn world, changelings must protect themselves against many dangers. With their chimerical aspect threatened by the touch of Banality, and with their physical bodies frail shells no more durable than any mortal's, none of these threats are easily ignored.